STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3410
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **12/03/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES **N.R.S. 60-6114 AND 60-6151**			
SUBJECT RESPONSE STATUS	CROSS REFERENCE P-3400 CALLS FOR SERVICE P-3430 RESCUE CALLS P-3440 ALARMS P-3450 FIRES P-4100 PURSUITS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the use of emergency lights and sirens when responding to calls.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office is committed to protecting the lives and property of the public in Sarpy County. To facilitate this commitment, deputies shall respond to emergency calls for service.

Deputies shall never drive in a careless, reckless, or negligent manner, and they shall always operate their law enforcement vehicles with due regard for the safety of all persons.

As a general rule, no person shall drive a vehicle on a highway at a speed greater than is reasonable and prudent under the conditions and having regard to the actual and potential hazards then existing. A person shall drive at a safe and appropriate speed when approaching and crossing an intersection or railroad grade crossing, when approaching and going around a curve, when approaching a hillcrest, when traveling upon any narrow or winding roadway, and when special hazards exist with respect to pedestrians or other traffic or by reason of weather or highway conditions (N.R.S. 60-6,185).

III. Definitions:

A. Urgent Status: Urgent status shall be the response to emergency calls that are life-threatening or most likely would result in a substantial property loss that involves a felony crime.

1. When responding urgent, deputies shall employ due regard for the safety of all persons and shall use all available emergency equipment to include:

a) Emergency Lights
b) Siren

2. Deputies responding to an emergency call or pursuing an actual or suspected violator of the law may (N.R.S. 60-6,114):

a) Stop, park, or stand, irrespective of the provisions of the state statutes;

b) Disregard regulations governing direction of movement or turning in specified directions. Effective April 1, 2025, deputies may respond against the flow of traffic (i.e. eastbound in the westbound lanes) when responding to crashes on Interstate 80 or controlled access highways within the corridor, when circumstances are such that the incident caused impediment to reach the crash site through proper traffic flow. Deputies shall ensure they are exercising due regard and traveling on the shoulders when available. This directive is due to extensive construction work on Interstate 80 between the I, L, Q street corridors to just east of Highway 370 beginning in the spring of 2025.

c) Proceed past a steady red indication, a flashing red indication, or a stop sign, but only after slowing down as may be necessary for safe operation; and

d) Exceed the maximum speed limits so long as he or she does not endanger life, limb, or property.

B. **Normal Status:** Normal status shall be the standard response to calls for service. Deputies shall not use emergency equipment and they shall obey all traffic laws.

IV. Procedure:

A. Calls for Service - Urgent Status:

1. A reasonable person believes the call is life-threatening.

2. A reasonable person believes there a serious risk of substantial property loss associated with a felony crime.

3. The deputy's immediate presence will have a measurable impact on the outcome.

B. Calls for Service - Normal Status:

1. Other emergency vehicles are en route or already on scene.

2. There is not an immediate need for a deputy at the scene.

C. Other Considerations:

1. Deputies and their supervisors are obligated to judge the merits of each specific call to determine the proper response status.

2. Responding urgent status is not permitted if there is unnecessary risk to the public.

3. Only two law enforcement vehicles may respond urgent status to a call. This provision, however, may be waived by a supervisor depending on the merits of the call.

4. Deputies shall consider other factors, including, but not limited to:

a) Road Conditions
b) Weather Conditions
c) Environmental Conditions
d) Traffic and Pedestrian Volume
e) Location
f) Time of Day
g) Distance from Call

D. Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Notification:

a) Deputies shall immediately notify Communications via the radio of their location and their urgent response status when dispatched an emergency call.

b) Deputies shall also advise Communications via the radio if they change response status at any time.

2. Use of Emergency Equipment:

a) Deputies may avoid using a siren near a crime-in-progress call if it creates a tactical disadvantage to the deputies or might alert suspects of the deputies' impending arrival.

b) Deputies shall use all emergency equipment while in pursuit of a motor vehicle.

c) When conducting a traffic stop, emergency lights shall be used but the siren is not required. The siren shall be activated if the vehicle fails to stop.

d) Emergency lights shall be used when assisting motorists on or off the roadway and when parking on or off the roadway when the patrol unit's position creates a potential traffic hazard.

e) Deputies may be authorized to use emergency lights for traffic control events (e.g., parades, foot or bicycle races, and funeral escorts). Generally, sirens shall not be used in these situations.

E. Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. Supervisors shall ensure the appropriate response status is selected by responding deputies.

2. Supervisors shall ensure no more than two law enforcement vehicles respond urgent status to an emergency call. This provision, however, may be waived by a supervisor depending on the merits of the call.

3. Supervisors may be held accountable for inappropriate response status decisions made by subordinates.

F. Response Status: This non-exhaustive list provides the typical response status to calls for service. However, deputies and their superiors are obligated to judge the merits of each specific call to determine the proper response status.

Again, deputies shall never drive in a careless, reckless, or negligent manner, and they shall always operate their law enforcement vehicles with due regard for the safety of all persons.

1. Normal Status:

a) Alarm: Intrusion (Residential or Business)
b) Rescue or Fire Call: Non-Life-Threatening
c) Property Crime: In Progress

d) Domestic Violence: Verbal
e) Preserve the Peace
f) Property Damage Crash

2. Urgent Status:
a) Alarm: Residential (Panic or Medical)
b) Alarm: Bank or Business (Hold-Up)
c) Alarm: Domestic Violence
d) Domestic Violence: Physical
e) Burglary or Robbery: In Progress
f) Rescue or Fire Call: Life-Threatening
g) Personal Injury Crash

3. Miscellaneous:
Help an Officer Call - More than two law enforcement cruisers may respond urgent status without authorization from a supervisor.